



List of Detroit Lions seasons

The Detroit Lions are a professional American football team based in Detroit, Michigan. The Lions compete in the National Football League (NFL) as a member of the North Division of the National Football Conference (NFC).^[2] The franchise was founded in Portsmouth, Ohio, as the Portsmouth Spartans and joined the NFL on July 12, 1930.^[3] After being purchased by George A. Richards in 1934, the franchise was relocated to Detroit and renamed to the Detroit Lions in reference to the city's Major League Baseball (MLB) franchise, the Detroit Tigers.^{[4][5]} The team plays its home games at Ford Field in Downtown Detroit.^[6]

The Lions have won four NFL championships, all of which pre-date the existence of the Super Bowl. The Lions' four championships are tied for the tenth most total championships amongst all 32 NFL franchises;^[7] the last of these was in 1957, which gives the club the second-longest NFL championship drought behind the Arizona Cardinals.^[8] They are one of four current teams, and the only one in the NFC, to have never played in the Super Bowl.^[9] Two of these teams, the Jacksonville Jaguars and the Houston Texans, are expansion teams in the AFC that began play in 1995 and 2002 respectively.^[10] Additionally, the Lions have won only three post-season games since 1957.^{[11][12][13]} The Lions lost an NFL-record nine consecutive playoff games from 1991 to 2023, for which they hold the NFL record for worst playoff winning percentage.^{[14][7]}

As of the end of the 2023 regular season, the Lions have an all-time record of 591 wins, 707 losses, and 34 ties in the regular season, with an additional 9 wins and 14 losses in the playoffs. The team has had 39 winning seasons, 49 losing seasons, and 6 seasons with as many wins as losses.^{[15][3][4]} The Lions were the first franchise to finish a full (non-strike shortened) regular season with no wins or ties, since the move to sixteen regular season games in 1978, going 0–16 during the 2008 NFL season.^[16]



The Detroit Lions have played their home games at Ford Field since 2002.^[1]

Seasons

Legend	
(#)	The order of league championship won by the franchise
Finish	Final position in league, division, or conference
T-#	Finished tied in that position with one or more teams
Pct	The team's <u>winning percentage</u> for the season
†	<u>NFL champions</u> (1920–1969)
‡	<u>Super Bowl champions</u> (1970–present)
*	Conference champions
^	Division champions
\$	Wild Card berth
°	<u>One-game playoff berth</u>



Lions head coach Dan Campbell played for the team during the 2006–2008 seasons and has been their head coach since 2021.^[17]

Detroit Lions record by season

Season	Team	League	Conference	Division	Regular season					Postseason results	Awards	Head coach	Refs
					Finish	W	L	T	Pct				
<u>1930</u>	<u>1930</u>	NFL			8th	5	6	3	.464	The NFL did not hold playoff games until 1932 ^[18]		Hal Griffen	[19]
<u>1931</u>	<u>1931</u>	NFL			2nd	11	3	0	.786			George "Potsy" Clark	[20]
<u>1932</u>	<u>1932</u>	NFL			3rd ^[A]	6	2	4	.667		Lost Playoff Game (at Bears) 0–9		
<u>1933</u>	<u>1933</u>	NFL		Western ^[B]	2nd	6	5	0	.545				[25]
<u>1934</u>	<u>1934</u>	NFL		Western	2nd	10	3	0	.769			George "Potsy" Clark	[26]
<u>1935</u>	<u>1935</u>	NFL [†]		Western [^]	1st [^]	7	3	2	.667	Won NFL Championship ⁽¹⁾ (Giants) 26–7			[27][C]
<u>1936</u>	<u>1936</u>	NFL		Western	3rd	8	4	0	.667				[29]
<u>1937</u>	<u>1937</u>	NFL		Western	T–2nd	7	4	0	.636			Dutch Clark	[30][D]
<u>1938</u>	<u>1938</u>	NFL		Western	2nd	7	4	0	.636				[31]
<u>1939</u>	<u>1939</u>	NFL		Western	3rd	6	5	0	.545			Gus Henderson	[32]
<u>1940</u>	<u>1940</u>	NFL		Western	3rd	5	5	1	.500			George "Potsy" Clark	[33]
<u>1941</u>	<u>1941</u>	NFL		Western	3rd	4	6	1	.409			Bill Edwards	[34]
<u>1942</u>	<u>1942</u>	NFL		Western	5th	0	11	0	.000			Bill Edwards (0–3) John Karcis (0–8)	[35]
<u>1943</u>	<u>1943</u>	NFL		Western	3rd	3	6	1	.350			Gus Dorais	[36][E]
<u>1944</u>	<u>1944</u>	NFL		Western	T–2nd	6	3	1	.650		Frank Sinkwich (MVP)		[37][38]
<u>1945</u>	<u>1945</u>	NFL		Western	2nd	7	3	0	.700				[39]
<u>1946</u>	<u>1946</u>	NFL		Western	5th	1	10	0	.091				[40][F]
<u>1947</u>	<u>1947</u>	NFL		Western	5th	3	9	0	.250				[41][G]
<u>1948</u>	<u>1948</u>	NFL		Western	5th	2	10	0	.167			Bo McMillin	[42]
<u>1949</u>	<u>1949</u>	NFL		Western	4th	4	8	0	.333				[43]
<u>1950</u>	<u>1950</u>	NFL	National ^[H]		4th	6	6	0	.500				[46]
<u>1951</u>	<u>1951</u>	NFL	National		T–2nd	7	4	1	.625			Buddy Parker	[47]
<u>1952</u>	<u>1952</u>	NFL [†]	National [*]		T–1st [°]	9	3	0	.750	Won Conference Playoff (Rams) 31–21 Won NFL Championship ⁽²⁾ (at Browns) 17–7			[48]
<u>1953</u>	<u>1953</u>	NFL [†]	Western ^{*[I]}		1st [*]	10	2	0	.833	Won NFL Championship ⁽³⁾ (Browns) 17–16			[50]
<u>1954</u>	<u>1954</u>	NFL	Western [*]		1st [*]	9	2	1	.792	Lost NFL Championship (at Browns) 10–56			[51]
<u>1955</u>	<u>1955</u>	NFL	Western		6th	3	9	0	.250				[52]
<u>1956</u>	<u>1956</u>	NFL	Western		2nd	9	3	0	.750				[53]
<u>1957</u>	<u>1957</u>	NFL [†]	Western [*]		1st [*]	8	4	0	.667	Won Conference Playoff (at 49ers) 31–27	George Wilson (COY)	George Wilson	[54][55]
Totals 5 Division titles 4 Conference titles 4 NFL titles						591	707	34	.456	All-time regular season record (1930–2023)			[15]
						9	14	—	.391	All-time postseason record (1930–2023)			
						600	721	34	.455	All-time regular & postseason record (1930–2023)			

Season	Team	League	Conference	Division	Regular season					Postseason results	Awards	Head coach	Refs
					Finish	W	L	T	Pct				
										Won NFL Championship ⁽⁴⁾ (Browns) 59–14			
<u>1958</u>	<u>1958</u>	NFL	Western		5th	4	7	1	.375				[56]
<u>1959</u>	<u>1959</u>	NFL	Western		5th	3	8	1	.292				[57]
<u>1960</u>	<u>1960</u>	NFL	Western		T–2nd ^o	7	5	0	.583	Won Playoff Bowl ^[J] (vs. Browns) 17–16			[59]
<u>1961</u>	<u>1961</u>	NFL	Western		2nd ^o	8	5	1	.607	Won Playoff Bowl ^[J] (vs. Eagles) 38–10			[60] [K]
<u>1962</u>	<u>1962</u>	NFL	Western		2nd ^o	11	3	0	.786	Won Playoff Bowl ^[J] (vs. Steelers) 17–10			[62]
<u>1963</u>	<u>1963</u>	NFL	Western		T–4th	5	8	1	.393				[63]
<u>1964</u>	<u>1964</u>	NFL	Western		4th	7	5	2	.571				[64]
<u>1965</u>	<u>1965</u>	NFL	Western		6th	6	7	1	.464			Harry Gilmer	[65]
<u>1966</u>	<u>1966</u>	NFL	Western		T–6th	4	9	1	.321				[66]
<u>1967</u>	<u>1967</u>	NFL	Western	Central ^[L]	3rd	5	7	2	.429		Mel Farr (OROY) Lem Barney (DROY)	Joe Schmidt	[68] [69] [70]
<u>1968</u>	<u>1968</u>	NFL	Western	Central	4th	4	8	2	.357		Earl McCullough (OROY)		[71] [72]
<u>1969</u>	<u>1969</u>	NFL	Western	Central	2nd	9	4	1	.679				[73]
<u>1970</u>	<u>1970</u>	NFL	NFC ^[M]	Central	2nd [§]	10	4	0	.714	Lost Divisional Playoffs (at Cowboys) 0–5			[76]
<u>1971</u>	<u>1971</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	2nd	7	6	1	.536				[77]
<u>1972</u>	<u>1972</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	2nd	8	5	1	.607				[78]
<u>1973</u>	<u>1973</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	2nd	6	7	1	.464			Don McCafferty	[79]
<u>1974</u>	<u>1974</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	2nd	7	7	0	.500			Rick Forzano	[80]
<u>1975</u>	<u>1975</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	2nd	7	7	0	.500				[81]
<u>1976</u>	<u>1976</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	3rd	6	8	0	.429		Greg Landry (CBPOY)	Rick Forzano (1–3) Tommy Hudspeth (5–5)	[82] [83]
<u>1977</u>	<u>1977</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	3rd	6	8	0	.429			Tommy Hudspeth	[84]
<u>1978</u>	<u>1978</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	3rd	7	9	0	.438		Al Baker (DROY)	Monte Clark	[85] [86] [N]
<u>1979</u>	<u>1979</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	5th	2	14	0	.125				[88]
<u>1980</u>	<u>1980</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	2nd	9	7	0	.563		Billy Sims (OROY)		[89] [90]
<u>1981</u>	<u>1981</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	2nd	8	8	0	.500				[91]
<u>1982</u>	<u>1982</u>	NFL	NFC	None ^[O]	8th ^{§[O]}	4	5	0	.444	Lost First Round Playoffs (at Redskins) 7–31			[93]
<u>1983</u>	<u>1983</u>	NFL	NFC	Central [^]	1st [^]	9	7	0	.563	Lost Divisional Playoffs (at 49ers) 23–24			[94]
<u>1984</u>	<u>1984</u>	NFL	NFC	Central	4th	4	11	1	.281				[95]
Totals 5 Division titles 4 Conference titles 4 NFL titles						591	707	34	.456	All-time regular season record (1930–2023)			[15]
						9	14	—	.391	All-time postseason record (1930–2023)			
						600	721	34	.455	All-time regular & postseason record (1930–2023)			

Season	Team	League	Conference	Division	Regular season					Postseason results	Awards	Head coach	Refs
					Finish	W 	L 	T 	Pct 				
1985	1985	NFL	NFC	Central	4th	7	9	0	.438			Darryl Rogers	^[96]
1986	1986	NFL	NFC	Central	3rd	5	11	0	.313				^[97]
1987	1987	NFL	NFC	Central	5th	4	11	0	.267				^[98] ^[P]
1988	1988	NFL	NFC	Central	4th	4	12	0	.250			Darryl Rogers 	

Season	Team	League	Conference	Division	Regular season					Postseason results	Awards	Head coach	Refs
					Finish	W	L	T	Pct				
2010	2010	NFL	NFC	North	3rd	6	10	0	.375		Ndamukong Suh (DROY)		[125] [126]
2011	2011	NFL	NFC	North	2nd [§]	10	6	0	.625	Lost Wild Card Playoffs (at Saints) 28–45	Matthew Stafford (CBPOY)		[127] [128]
2012	2012	NFL	NFC	North	4th	4	12	0	.250				[129]
2013	2013	NFL	NFC	North	3rd	7	9	0	.438				[130]
2014	2014	NFL	NFC	North	2nd [§]	11	5	0	.688	Lost Wild Card Playoffs (at Cowboys) 20–24		Jim Caldwell	[131]
2015	2015	NFL	NFC	North	3rd	7	9	0	.438				[132]
2016	2016	NFL	NFC	North	2nd [§]	9	7	0	.563	Lost Wild Card Playoffs (at Seahawks) 6–26			[133]
2017	2017	NFL	NFC	North	2nd	9	7	0	.563				[134]
2018	2018	NFL	NFC	North	4th	6	10	0	.375			Matt Patricia	[135]
2019	2019	NFL	NFC	North	4th	3	12	1	.219				[136]
2020	2020	NFL	NFC	North	4th	5	11	0	.313			Matt Patricia (4–7) Darrell Bevell (1–4)	[137]
2021	2021	NFL	NFC	North	4th	3	13	1	.206			Dan Campbell	[138] [R]
2022	2022	NFL	NFC	North	2nd	9	8	0	.529				[140]
2023	2023	NFL	NFC	North ^A	1st ^A	12	5	0	.706	Won Wild Card Playoffs (Rams) 24–23 Won Divisional Playoffs (Buccaneers) 31–23 Lost NFC Championship (at 49ers) 31–34			[141]
Totals 5 Division titles 4 Conference titles 4 NFL titles						591	707	34	.456	All-time regular season record (1930–2023)			[15]
						9	14	—	.391	All-time postseason record (1930–2023)			
						600	721	34	.455	All-time regular & postseason record (1930–2023)			

See also

- History of the Detroit Lions
- List of Detroit Lions first-round draft picks
- List of Detroit Lions head coaches

Notes

A. Finished tied for first (by winning percentage) at 6–1–4; lost tiebreaker playoff game to the Bears, which dropped them to 3rd place (by winning percentage). The tiebreaker game was considered a regular season game, so 3rd place at 6–2–4 is the Spartans' final standing.^[21]

B. Prior to 1933, the NFL determined their league champions based on win–loss percentage. After a tie for first place in 1932, the NFL arranged an extra regular season game to determine the season's champion. Based on the success of this matchup, George Preston Marshall and George Halas put forth a proposal to determine the league's champion in a championship match at the end of each season. In 1933, the NFL divided teams into two divisions, with the division champions set to meet in the NFL Championship Game.^{[23][24]}

C. In 1935, the NFL set the number of regular season games to 12. Prior to that, the NFL did not have a set number of games for teams to play.^[28]

D. In 1937, the NFL lowered the number of regular season games, which had been 12 games since 1935, to 11.^[28]

E. In 1943, the NFL again lowered the number of regular season games, which had been 11 games since 1937, to 10.^[28]

F. In 1946, the NFL expanded its regular season schedule, which had been 10 games since 1943, to 11 games.^[28]

G. In 1947, the NFL expanded its regular season schedule, which had been 11 games since 1946, to 12 games.^[28]

- H. In 1950, the NFL merged with the All-America Football Conference (AAFC) to become the "National-American Football League". Teams were no longer part of divisions, instead being placed into the newly created National and American conferences. The NFL reverted the name change roughly three months later.^{[44][45]}
- I. In 1953, the NFL renamed the American conference to the Eastern conference and the National conference to the Western conference. No teams changed conferences as a result of this.^[49]
- J. The **Playoff Bowl** (played between 1960–1969) was a post-season exhibition game to determine third place.^[58]
- K. In 1961, the NFL expanded its regular season schedule, which had been 12 games since 1947, to 14 games.^{[28][61]}
- L. In 1967, the NFL realigned teams from the existing two conferences into newly created divisions. The Eastern conference contained the Capitol and Century divisions while the Western conference contained the Central and Coastal divisions.^[67]
- M. In 1970, the NFL and American Football League (AFL) officially merged in the **AFL–NFL merger** to form one league with two conferences. All ten former AFL teams as well as Pittsburgh, Cleveland, and Baltimore from the pre-merger NFL joined the AFC; the other thirteen remaining NFL teams joined the NFC. Each of those two were divided into three divisions: East, Central, and West.^{[74][75]}
- N. In 1978, the NFL expanded its regular season schedule, which had been 14 games since 1961, to 16 games.^{[28][87]}
- O. The 1982 season was shortened to nine games after a **players' strike**. The top eight teams in each conference advanced to the playoffs.^[92]
- P. The 1987 NFL strike caused the schedule to be reduced to 15 games.^[99]
- Q. In 2002, the NFL realigned to create four divisions in both conferences with four teams in each division.^[116]
- R. In 2021, the NFL expanded its regular season schedule, which had been 16 games since 1978, to 17 games.^{[28][139]}

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